



## Advanced fingerprinting

Researchers at Sheffield Hallam University have developed a way to capture fingerprints that can identify substances touched, and secretions from a person's body.



## Predict Tree Height

Scientists at MIT have developed a mathematical model to estimate the probable height of a tree under various conditions. <http://bit.ly/oz7QRp>

# HTC ChaCha

## Singing a soothing tone

It is true that the HTC ChaCha sings a completely different tune- mid range Android smartphone offering a touchscreen and physical QWERTY keypad. We have the Samsung Galaxy Pro for the lower end of the market, while the HTC Desire Z caters to the higher end.

Straight off, the looks of the phone will catch your attention. While there is nothing very different, there are these little things that make a difference. The slight banana curve makes typing a lot more comfortable. The little "F" button lets you post on Facebook with just one click.

However, while this phone essentially shows off the social networking capabilities, the real

value pack is the touchscreen and physical keypad combo. The dual capabilities will appeal to those who want a touch device, and also to those who want a physical QWERTY keypad for their mails and messages. The ChaCha is built well. Despite the plasticky looks, the phone does feel very solid. No creaks or rough edges anywhere. What is really impressive is the typing experience offered by the keypad. No problems with the key size – they are adequately big and well spaced out. Key-press is quite soft, so much so that even the keypad of the phone you are used to will start feeling a little uncomfortable!



The "F" button, for all its hype, lets you only post to Facebook, and not much else.

To read the timeline, comment on posts or chat, you will still need to use the official Facebook app.

Call quality offered is okay, but the phone does tend to lose some grunt at high volumes, both for the earpiece and the speaker. No problems with the quality though. The battery life however, is a huge disappointment. With just a few calls, SMS and FB chat running in the background, the ChaCha barely lasts a day. Absolutely no doubt that this phone needs a higher capacity battery.

*Visbal Mathur*

## Specifications

**Platform:** Android 2.3.3;  
**Processor:** 800MHz;  
**RAM:** 512MB; **Display:** 2.6-inch HVGA capacitive touchscreen 480x320 display, pixel resolution;  
**Keyboard:** Full QWERTY type; **Memory:** microSD slot up to 32GB; **Camera:** 5MP; **Battery:** 1250 mAh

## Contact

**HTC India**  
**Phone:** 1800-1033566  
**Web site:** [www.htc.com/in](http://www.htc.com/in)  
**Price:** ₹15,990

7.0  
10

Features.....7.0  
Performance.....6.0  
Build Quality .....7.5  
Value for Money .....6.5

## Specifications

**Screen:** 13.3-inch matte, 1366x768 resolution / **CPU:** 2.7-GHz Intel Core i7-2620M / **RAM:** 8GB DDR3 / **HDD:** 128GB SSD / **GPU:** Onboard Intel HD 3000 / **OS:** Windows 7 Ultimate 64-bit / **Ports:** 2 x USB, HDMI, VGA, eSATA, card reader, fingerprint reader, more / **Weight:** 1.7-kg

## Contact

**Dell India Pvt. Ltd.**  
**Phone:** 1800-425-4002  
**Web site:** [www.dell.co.in](http://www.dell.co.in)  
**Price:** ₹1,32,137

8.0  
10

Features.....8.0  
Performance.....8.5  
Build Quality .....8.0  
Value for Money .....7.0

# Dell Latitude E6320

## Elegant business performer

The new 13-inch Latitude E6320 is Dell's Rolls-Royce of a business laptop, combining strong build, elegant design and powerful performance for executives that need a portable, uncompromising laptop. It takes on competing laptops like the Lenovo ThinkPad X1 (<http://goo.gl/mvK3l>) and Apple's MacBook Air ultraportables.

The Latitude E6320 is built very well, its screen lid is made of anodized aluminum (scratch resistant) fitted in a magnesium alloy frame and secured to the powder-coated plastic chassis with two steel hinges. Dell has spared no expense in ensuring the laptop feels elegant on touch, be its brushed screen lid or

smooth palmrest. There isn't a hint of gloss on the E6320, ensuring fingerprint smudges are down to a minimum.

The laptop comes with dual-input keyboard, like the Lenovo ThinkPad X1 – a standard trackpad and additional trackpoint navigation. The rubber-tipped keys are concave and a treat to type on, the pointing stick for navigation is great to use as well. The laptop's matte screen is well lit and good for reading text, not so much for multimedia usage. With the kind of internal hardware present on the Dell Latitude E6320, performance is never going to be a problem. Multitasking with



regular office suites, video conferencing, listening to music, and browsing the web is easily taken care of, no problems whatsoever.

The laptop's battery life isn't great though, lasting just over 70 minutes in our synthetic test – expect just about 3 hours (or less) on a conservative power plan. That's about the only blemish on this otherwise stylish ultraportable business laptop which sells at a very high premium.

*Jayesh Shinde*